Jay Stewart

Software engineer. Backend, payments and AI.

Open to remote roles, permanent or contract

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PROFILE

Eight years of e-commerce and payments backends. Now I build and run SpiralClass in production with coding agents: real payments, live video with translated captions, and an LLM pipeline that turns each class into learning notes the teacher checks. Looking for a remote role, permanent or contract.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer (independent)

Mar 2026 – now

SpiralClass `live · real payments` Booking, payments and video for independent teachers. Built and run solo.

- Stripe Connect direct charges: the teacher is merchant of record; the platform never holds funds.
- Live captions translated in class: browser speech recognition, Deepgram for phones, on-device or Google translation. No server listens.
- Post-class LLM pipeline: Claude with forced tool calls and zod-validated output turns the transcript into findings the teacher confirms before they count. Consent-gated; models split by call shape for cost.
- Next.js, Postgres (82 models), LiveKit video. 9,351 unit tests behind one merge gate. 146 decision records.

Career break

Mar 2020 – Mar 2026

Six years travelling on savings. Back because coding agents changed what one person can ship.

Backend Engineer · G&V | Venture Brands Agency (contract) · Bristol

Jul 2017 – Mar 2020

- High-traffic e-commerce, including Dyson's store. Fixed production issues where an outage meant lost orders.

Full Stack Developer · Thrive Chiropractic (contract, remote)

Aug 2016 – Mar 2020

- Sole developer, from requirements with the practice to running their booking and payments platform (Laravel).

Backend Engineer · Folk Digital, now We Are Folk, Poole; C3 Media, Bristol

Jul 2012 – Aug 2016

- Full stack at C3, from junior PHP developer to whole sites; then backend at Folk on luxury fashion stores.

HOW I WORK

- **Care about money and production.** Payments reconcile to the right person; rules are tested against a real database.
- **Write things down.** A short update each day; decisions live in the pull request or issue.
- **I own what the agents write.** Every change gets a pull request, tests and a real-browser check.

SKILLS

Stack	TypeScript, Next.js, React, Node, Postgres, Prisma, Go, Cloudflare Workers; PHP and Magento before 2020
AI engineering	Claude API, structured outputs, prompt tests, Deepgram, Google speech and translation, Claude Code
Payments and ops	Stripe Connect, Wise; GitHub Actions, Docker, Cloud Run, Sentry, PostHog; CI gates, browser testing
Languages	English (native), Spanish (conversational)